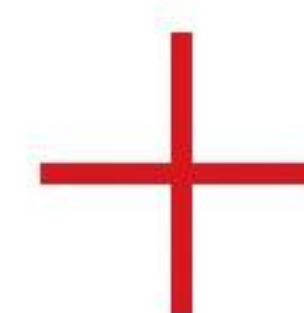




FOR MORE
STORIES



RCB Season-wise Finishes in IPL

2008: Seventh - 8 points, 4 wins, 10 losses
2009: Third - 16 points, 8 wins, 6 losses (final)
2010: Fourth - 14 points, 7 wins, 7 losses
2011: First - 19 points, 9 wins, 4 losses (final)
2012: Fifth - 17 points, 8 wins, 7 losses
2013: Fifth - 18 points, 9 wins, 7 losses
2014: Seventh - 10 points, 5 wins, 9 losses
2015: Third - 16 points, 7 wins, 5 losses (Qualifier 2)
2016: Second - 16 points, 8 wins, 6 losses (final)
2017: Eighth - 7 points, 3 wins, 10 losses
2018: Sixth - 12 points, 6 wins, 8 losses
2019: Eighth - 11 points, 5 wins, 8 losses
2020: Fourth - 14 points, 7 wins, 7 losses (eliminator)
2021: Third - 18 points, 9 wins, 5 losses (eliminator)
2022: Fourth - 16 points, 8 wins, 6 losses (qualifier 2)
2023: Sixth - 14 points, 7 wins, 7 losses
2024: Fourth - 14 points, 7 wins, 7 losses (eliminator)
2025: Second - 19 points, 9 wins, 4 losses (WINNER)

Legendary reunion: Virat Kohli celebrated RCB's first IPL title in 18 years alongside former stars AB de Villiers and Chris Gayle, who joined the festivities. PTI

the system, we worked closely. We knew we were backing the right person. Our interest was always on commitment and character. Rajat had those two qualities in ample and once we were sure of that, we only had to work on the technical aspects," Khurasiya, a former India international, explained.

Khurasiya had also once recommended Patidar and Kuldeep Sen to Kings XI Punjab (now Punjab

Kings) as a scout. That didn't materialise. Ironically, years later, it was Patidar who dashed Punjab's hopes in a final.

Patidar's journey hasn't been smooth. "When you are not born with a silver spoon, you have to struggle," Khurasiya said. "He had to take five steps back in a bid to move one step forward."

But when the final was won, Kohli hugged Patidar. They had travelled very different paths — one a prodigy turned global star, the other a late bloomer. But over time, Kohli mentored him and helped ignite the fire that powered this campaign.

Together, they had finally brought the trophy home.



Flower's foresight: RCB head coach Andy Flower is known for thorough preparation well ahead of auctions. His team reaps the rewards.

K. MURALI KUMAR